MCKINNEY-VENTO PD · DURING THE VIDEO

Notice · Refer · Protect

Name / School: _____

While you watch, jot at least one idea in each column. You'll use these notes in the group activities.

Notice

Signs I might see in my classroom, office or hallway

Refer

Who I would tell, and how quickly

Protect

What I must keep private, and what must never become a barrier

City Schools McKinney-Vento Liaison: 443-642-2424 · My school's McKinney-Vento liaison: _____

AGREE

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree Line-Up

DISAGREE

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree Line-Up

ACTIVITY 2 · BEFORE THE VIDEO

Guess the Number

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. One slip per table.

Table guess

How many Maryland students were identified as experiencing homelessness in 2023–24?

How many of them were in Baltimore City?

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ACTIVITY 4 · AFTER THE VIDEO

Who Qualifies? Sorting Mat

Place each scenario card in a column. Remember: staff don't decide eligibility; the McKinney-Vento liaison does. **When in doubt, refer.**

Likely eligible

Refer to the McKinney-Vento liaison

Not enough information

Refer, and let the liaison decide

Likely not eligible

Fixed, regular and adequate housing

Discuss

Which cards caused the most debate? Why is "refer when unsure" the safest rule?

✂ Activity 4 · Who Qualifies? Scenario cards: cut along the dashed lines

1 SCENARIO

Maya's family lost their apartment after a fire. They're staying in a relative's basement.

2 SCENARIO

Andre's family lives in a motel because they can't afford a deposit on an apartment.

3 SCENARIO

Jasmine, 17, left home after conflict with her parents and is sleeping at friends' houses.

4 SCENARIO

The Lee family sold their house and is renting while their new home is built.

5 SCENARIO

Carlos and his mom sleep in their car some nights and at a shelter on others.

6 SCENARIO

Tiana's family moved in with her grandmother. Tiana mentions "we had to leave our old place."

7 SCENARIO

A newly enrolled student has no records and says they're "staying with people."

8 SCENARIO

Jordan lives in a trailer with no running water or electricity.

✂ Activity 5 · Barrier Busters: one card per table

1 BARRIER

The front office tells a mother her son can't start until she brings a lease and immunization records.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

2 BARRIER

A student who moved to a shelter across town has missed four days because there's no way to get to school.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

3 BARRIER

A student can't go on a field trip because the $25 fee is overdue.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

4 BARRIER

A student keeps getting sent to the office for not wearing a uniform.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

5 BARRIER

A family and the school disagree about whether the student qualifies. The school says the student must stay home until it's resolved.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

6 BARRIER

A student hasn't eaten breakfast because the family hasn't filled out a meal form.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

✂ Activity 6 · The Right Words: one set per group of three. Rotate roles for each scenario.

A ROLE-PLAY

A usually on-time 4th grader has been late all week, falling asleep in class, and wearing the same clothes.

B ROLE-PLAY

A 10th grader mentions they've been "couch surfing" and asks you not to tell anyone.

C ROLE-PLAY

A parent at pickup says they're "between places right now" and worried about their child changing schools.

Observer checklist

- [ ] Spoke privately, not in front of others
- [ ] Used neutral words ("Where are you staying right now?") rather than "Are you homeless?"
- [ ] Didn't promise secrecy they can't keep, but explained that information is shared only with people who can help
- [ ] Named the next step: the school's McKinney-Vento liaison
- [ ] Didn't make the student or family prove anything

Phrases that worked

ACTIVITY 7 · CLOSING

Our School Action Map

School: _____

1. Our McKinney-Vento liaison

Name, room, extension. Citywide line: 443-642-2424

2. Where students might be noticed

Front office, attendance, nurse, cafeteria, buses, coaches…

3. Our referral steps

Who tells whom, how quickly, and how it stays confidential

4. One barrier we'll remove this month

Uniform closet, grab-and-go breakfast, front-office enrollment script…

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

1 _____

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

1 _____

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

Answer Key

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree statements

Statement	Answer
1. A student living with their aunt's family because they were evicted counts as homeless under federal law.	Agree: doubled up because of lost housing
2. A school can wait to enroll a student until the family brings proof of address.	Disagree: enrollment is immediate, even without records
3. A student who moves to a shelter across the city has to change schools.	Disagree: can stay in school of origin when in their best interest, with transportation
4. Teachers should tell the class when a student is homeless, so classmates can help.	Disagree: housing status is confidential
5. A 16-year-old living on their own, without a parent, can enroll themselves in school.	Agree: unaccompanied youth are covered and enrolled right away

Activity 2 · Guess the Number

20,402 statewide; 5,732 in Baltimore City (MSDE, 2023–24). That's more than 1 in 4 of the state total and about 1 in 13 City Schools students, or about 38 students in a school of 500.

Activity 4 · Who Qualifies?

Likely eligible	Not enough information: refer	Likely not eligible
1 (doubled up after fire), 2 (motel, no alternative), 3 (unaccompanied youth), 5 (car and shelter), 8 (inadequate housing)	6 (reason for the move matters), 7 (needs a private conversation with the liaison)	4 (planned move, fixed and adequate housing)

Activity 5 · Barrier Busters

#	Right at stake → what should happen
1	Immediate enrollment without records; the liaison helps get them afterward
2	School of origin with transportation; call the McKinney-Vento liaison right away
3	Full access to activities; fee waivers through the McKinney-Vento Program
4	Uniforms and clothing are available through the program; don't discipline for what the student can't control
5	Student is enrolled and attends while the dispute is resolved
6	Automatic eligibility for free meals; no form needed

Sources: 42 U.S.C. §§ 11431–11435 and § 1758(b)(12); MSDE Homeless Education Trend Data 2018–2024. Full list in SOURCES.md.